

Starting the Solver

The `solve()` function is useful for kicking off the initial call to `attemptMove()`, but the program still needs to do some setup. The Python code for this is as follows:

Python

```
# Start the program:
SOLVED_BOARD = getNewBoard()
puzzleBoard = getNewPuzzle()
displayBoard(puzzleBoard)
startTime = time.time()
```

The JavaScript code for this setup is as follows:

JavaScript

```
// Start the program:
const SOLVED_BOARD = JSON.stringify(getNewBoard());
let puzzleBoard = getNewPuzzle();
displayBoard(puzzleBoard);
let startTime = Date.now();
```

First, the `SOLVED_BOARD` constant is set to an ordered, solved board as returned by `getNewBoard()`. This constant isn't set at the top of the source code because the `getNewBoard()` function needs to be defined before it can be called.

Next, a random puzzle is returned from `getNewPuzzle()` and stored in the `puzzleBoard` variable. This variable contains the puzzle board data structure that will be solved. If you want to solve a specific 15-puzzle instead of a random one, you can replace the call to `getNewPuzzle()` with a list or array containing the puzzle you do want to solve.

The board in `puzzleBoard` is displayed to the user, and the current time is stored in `startTime` so that the program can calculate the runtime of the algorithm. The Python code continues as follows:

Python